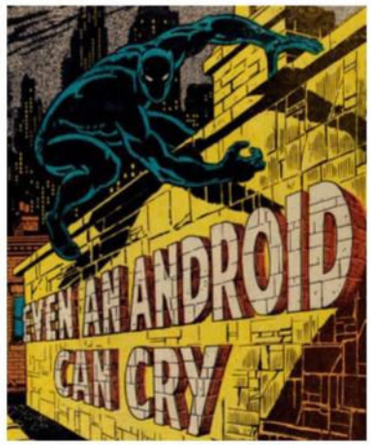
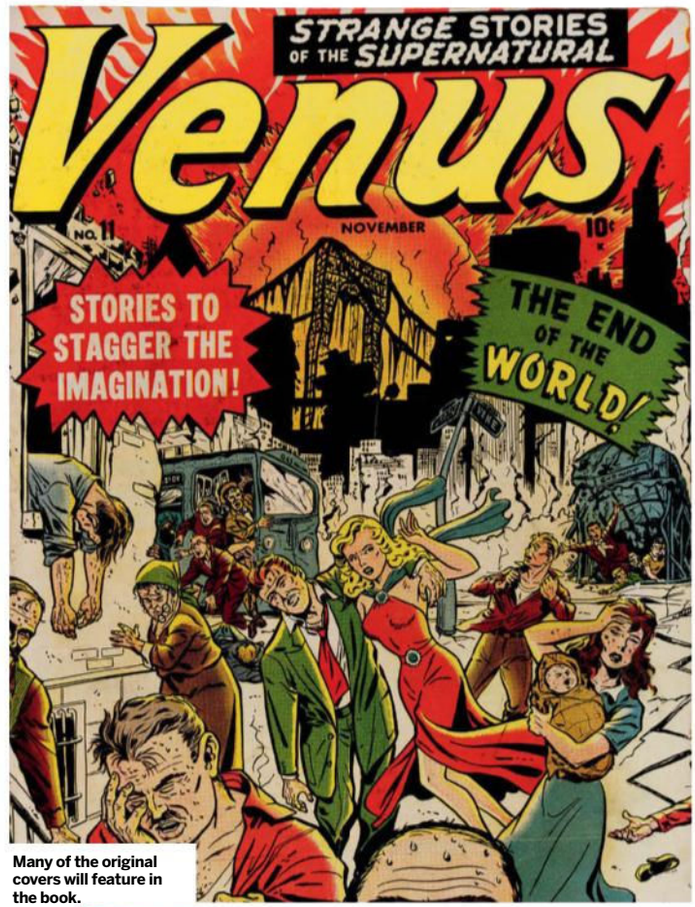






***The 75 Years Of Marvel* book includes all your favourite characters.**



Many of the original covers will feature in the book.

What was Stan Lee like to work with? And how about Jack Kirby and Steve Ditko?
Stan isn't perfect; no one is. But he was great to work with and a wonderful teacher, even when he wasn't really trying to be. I liked Jack, but never had much to do with him. Steve was distant, but we were friendly, and he once came to a party at the apartment I lived in, several years after he'd left Marvel. John Romita, Marie Severin, Herb Trimpe and Sol Brodsky, they were a great crew, but my favourite all-time collaborator was probably John Buscema.

How did you go abut bringing the rights to Conan to Marvel Comics?
Conan and his world are a wonderful concept, and [artist] Barry Smith and I did such a good job of bringing it to comics, ditto Gil Kane and John Buscema later. Why be overly modest? It didn't succeed because we did a lousy job, right?

Your fondness for the Golden Age was evident in the creation of *The Invaders*. Was that a highlight for you?
The Invaders was never a big hit, but it did okay. I thought it was a good way for me to write characters I loved, like the original Torch, Cap and Namor, without having to co-ordinate them with other comics. I was tired of being involved in the day-to-day Marvel universe, even though I'd done a fair amount to help solidify it.

You served as editor-in-chief from 1972-74. What was your focus then?
Mostly, we had to grow. My move to editor-in-chief and Stan's to publisher coincided with our mutual desire to try different genres. Marvel became the top comics company during that period, though due more to Stan and other factors. But I like to think I did my part to help it along. Sometimes I wish I'd stayed around longer as editor-in-chief, but I did a lot of other interesting things with my life after I left the job, so I can't really regret that.



You continued to write for Marvel, but later joined DC. How did the two companies compare?
I didn't want to work for Marvel if I couldn't continue to edit my own work, so when I got stonewalled, I left. DC did some great books in the Eighties – *Watchmen* and *The Dark Knight Returns* – but they're not to my taste, especially the latter. I find things I like, but they're not for me, despite my respect for their creators.

With Marvel's movie success, is it exciting to see your creations come to life?
Yes, especially seeing the Vision. What I've seen so far of the next *Avengers* movie [*Age Of Ultron*] makes me think I might like it nearly as much as – or even more than – the first, and I liked that one a lot. It's one of the few movies in recent years I've actually seen more than once.



THE TRIUMPH OF MAGNETO
***UNCANNY X-MEN* #60-63**
(1979)
A strange time in the X-Men's history, when the title faced cancellation. But that didn't stop Thomas and artist Neal Adams producing great work.



RETURN TO THE GOLDEN AGE
***ALL-STAR SQUADRON* #1-3**
(1981)
After moving to DC, Thomas got to explore his love of the company's Golden Age characters, launching an *All-Star* series set in the Forties.



THE GENERATIONS SAGA
***INFINITY INC* #1-10**
(1984)
Also at DC, Thomas span another series out of the All-Star Squadron, bringing a team together based on the heroes' offspring, created with artist Jerry Ordway.



75 Years Of Marvel: From The Golden Age To The Silver Screen by Roy Thomas and Josh Baker is available now, published by Taschen, RRP £135.

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